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Skills

Research methods: Qualitative interviews; focus groups; surveys; participant recruitment; field research; systematic literature review; qualitative data analysis; stakeholder research; knowledge mobilization.

Research communication: Academic writing; research reporting; grant writing; knowledge translation; research presentations.

Large-scale project and budget management (up to CAD 5M); multi-stakeholder engagement

Multilingual fieldwork capacity across French, Arabic, Ga, and Akan-speaking communities

Languages

English (native)

French (bilingual)

Arabic (advanced)

Gã (native)

Akan (bilingual)

IT skills

Qualtrics

NVivo

DEBORAH N. A. ALLOTEY

Researcher in Development, African Studies, and Black Entrepreneurship

Interdisciplinary researcher with academic and applied research experience spanning African Studies, African languages, Black entrepreneurship, economic participation, and community-engaged research. I hold an MA in Linguistics from Western University and a First Class Honours BA in Linguistics and Arabic from the University of Ghana, with peer-reviewed publications on Gã and Black entrepreneurship in Canada. I have several years of university-based research experience in entrepreneurship and economic participation, complemented by current work with the Black Entrepreneurship Knowledge Hub on community-focused research and knowledge mobilization. My doctoral research interests centre on how institutions, development policies, and economic structures shape the capacity of African economic actors to participate in structural transformation and inclusive development, with a particular interest in Ghana and West Africa.

PUBLICATIONS

Allotey, D.N.A., Pulsifer, P.L., Pierce, A.O. (2026). A Systematic Review of the Black Entrepreneurship Ecosystem and the Impact of Networks in Advancing Black Entrepreneurship in Canada. In: Zogning, F. (eds) Inclusive Entrepreneurship. Exploring Diversity in Entrepreneurship. Springer, Cham.
https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-18147-3_8

Allotey, D., & Paul, I. (2023). Overt PRO in Gã Vol. 52 No. 1 and 2 Studies in African Linguistics
<https://doi.org/10.32473/sal.52.1and2.131241>

Allotey, Deborah Naa Adorkor. (2021). Overt pronouns of infinitival predicates of Gã. Western Papers in Linguistics Vol. 4, No. 1.
https://ojs.lib.uwo.ca/index.php/wpl_clw/article/view/13693

EDUCATION

M.A. in Linguistics

Western University, London, ON, Canada

September 2018

June 2020

. Thesis: "Overt Pronouns in Infinitival Predicates of Gã"
. Mary Routledge Fellowship (2019); Chair's Entrance Scholarship (2018)
.

ArcGIS & QGIS

Zotero

R Programming

Best Student Paper Presentation, Canadian Linguistics Association
Congress (2020)

B.A. in Linguistics and Arabic

August 2011

University of Ghana, Legon-Accra, Ghana

May 2016

· First Class Honours; Best Graduating Student, University of Ghana (2016)

Certificate of Arabic Proficiency

September 2014

Ain Shams University, Cairo, Egypt

June 2015

· Graduated in the 95th percentile

WORK EXPERIENCE

Community Coordinator

April 2026

Black Entrepreneurship Knowledge Hub (BEKH),
Ottawa

Current

- Support the coordination of a national, community-focused research and knowledge platform addressing gaps in evidence on Black entrepreneurship and translating research findings into practical resources for entrepreneurs, organizations, and policymakers.
- Contribute to knowledge mobilization activities, including disseminating research findings, reports, playbooks, newsletters, digital content, and other accessible knowledge products to diverse audiences.
- Contribute to the translation of research and data into accessible, community-relevant insights and practical solutions aligned with BEKH's thematic priorities, including business growth and resilience, financing, investment readiness, digital adoption, and targeted interventions.
- Maintain and monitor stakeholder engagement activities and databases, and support reporting on engagement outcomes, partnership activities, and project performance indicators.

Ecosystem Mapping Coordinator

November 2022

Sprott School of Business, Carleton University-
, Ottawa

March 2026

- Conducted interdisciplinary research on the **Black entrepreneurship ecosystem in Canada**, examining the institutional, economic, and network conditions shaping Black entrepreneurs' participation and business development.
- Led and significantly contributed to **literature-based research and evidence synthesis**, including a systematic review examining the Black entrepreneurship ecosystem and the role of networks in advancing Black entrepreneurship in Canada.
- Translated research findings across academic and applied contexts through **research analysis, synthesis, scholarly writing, and knowledge products** relevant to entrepreneurship, economic participation, and community development.
- Contributed to the development and interpretation of **ecosystem-mapping research**, bringing together evidence on organizations, programs, networks, and institutional supports within the Black entrepreneurship landscape.

- Worked within an interdisciplinary research environment connecting **entrepreneurship, economic participation, social research, and development**, with attention to how institutional and ecosystem conditions affect economic opportunity.
- Applied research methods including **systematic literature review, qualitative research, evidence synthesis, stakeholder-oriented research, and research reporting**.
- Used research and data-analysis tools including **NVivo, Qualtrics, R, ArcGIS/QGIS, Zotero, and related research-management tools**.
- Produced peer-reviewed research from this work, including a **2026 Springer publication** on the Black entrepreneurship ecosystem and the impact of networks in advancing Black entrepreneurship in Canada.

Program Coordinator

July 2021

Global & International Studies, Carleton University,
Ottawa

November 2022

- Supported program and project development within an interdisciplinary academic environment.
- Coordinated activities involving multiple stakeholders.
- Contributed to recruitment, communications, product/project development, and operational activities.

Institute Administrator

September 2020

Institute of African Studies, Carleton University-
, Ottawa

June 2021

- Supported the activities of an academic institute focused on Africa and the African diaspora.
- Supported webinars, seminars, and academic programming, including the Institute's Brownbag Seminar Series and Knowing Africa Series.
- Developed experience working across academic, governmental, diplomatic, and community-facing environments.

Teaching and Research Assistant

September 2018

Department of Linguistics, Western University-
, London, Ontario

June 2020

- Conducted field research for MA thesis research involving West African immigrants and native speakers of Gã.
- Collected and analyzed linguistic data using research and analytical tools, including NVivo and Qualtrics.
- Presented research findings through conference posters and oral presentations, and contributed to two scholarly journal articles.
- Taught Syntax, Morphology and Phonology to first, third and fourth year students.

Teaching and Research Assistant

September 2016

Department of Modern Languages, University of
Ghana, Accra, Ghana

September 2017

- Supported teaching and academic activities within the Department of Modern Languages.
-

Taught Arabic Language Grammar, Arabic Language Literature and Arab History and Philosophy to second- and fourth-year undergraduate students.

Co-Founder

2012

Debbie's GH, Accra

2018

- Founded a women-led enterprise supporting local artisans and vendors in Ghana; provided entrepreneurial and product-quality training to improve incomes and market access.
- Secured over USD 4,000 in private and governmental start-up funding.
- Gained first-hand insight into informal enterprise, market constraints, and entrepreneurial networks in West Africa

Intern, Marketing Analyst

May 2015

DaViva Clothes and Fabrics, Ghana

September 2015

- Analysed consumer datasets and supported market research through field surveys, informing product and marketing recommendations.

● CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"The Canadian Black Entrepreneurship Ecosystem | L'écosystème canadien de l'entrepreneuriat noir "

April 2024

Casablanca, Morocco

"Overt Pronouns of Infinitival Predicates of Gã." Congress 2020, Canadian Linguistics Association — Best Student Paper Presentation.

June 2020

London, Ontario

<https://cla-acl.ca/prix-etudiants-student-awards.html>
<https://doi.org/10.1017/cnj.2020.25>

"Serial Verb Constructions: Comparing Gã with Existing Literature." Linguistic Society of America Linguistic Institute, UC Davis (15% acceptance rate).

July 2019

Sacramento, USA

"Overt Pronouns in Gã." 50th Annual Conference on African Linguistics, University of British Columbia (25% acceptance rate).

May 2019

Vancouver, British Columbia

● AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

2019

**Mary Routledge Fellowship, Western
University**

**Chair's Entrance Scholarship, Western
University**

2018

**Best Student Paper Presentation,
Canadian Linguistics Association
Congress**

2020

**Best Graduating Student, University of
Ghana**

2016